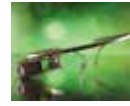




Mega wearables list

Probably one of the best compiled list we have come across, of all the wearables seen at CES 2015. <http://dgit.in/WearableDev>



The future looks bleak

Though there were many new concepts introduced to wearable technology, it's future's uncertain. <http://dgit.in/UncertFut>

Are we there yet?

From “the next big thing” to a proper product category in its own right, could 2015 finally be the year wearables really take off? (no pun intended) Let's find out...

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It's been a long time since we saw Pranav Mistry demonstrate his Sixth Sense wearable tech at that now fateful TED Talk. The year was 2009 to be precise and what we saw, we really wanted; the promise was so appealing. Considering it's been five years – in technology that's an epoch – by now we should've all been gesturing our way through life and our attire should have made The Borg feel perfectly at home around us. Somehow that hasn't happened and the wearables as a category hasn't lived up to the hype. All we have with us today are a few fitness bands and smartwatches that regular people have just about started adopting.

What took so long

Wearable devices have been the rage since a couple of years now, but after all this time, it hasn't become mainstream yet. When the storm of wearables arrived, the market was flooded with devices that were intended for the mostly fitness enthusiasts, in the form of health trackers. Somehow the industry was constrained into thinking wearables are something that you only wear on your wrist. But once the concepts of wearable technology and Internet of Things came across each other, it gave rise to an infinite number of possibilities to



Garmin Fenix 3 is a rugged smartwatch for the adventurous kind

wearable devices. Wearables took a considerably long time to hit its current stage, the reason still being unclear. The technology involved in them was allegedly very nascent initially, and hadn't matured enough. The modules and sensors that are incorporated now in wearable devices have drastically dropped in size, and have reached acceptable levels of efficiency. Another likely reason could be that the manufacturing process of such wearable devices wasn't economical enough

until now, and companies have finally come across technologies that make the entire process of building a wearable device more practical and profitable.

Why will we be seeing more wearables this year

For a couple of years, we have been observing wearable devices grow from its early years, and the device categories haven't reached a mainstream point yet. Wearables now only include devices that do simple tasks, tracking certain activities like the number of steps you've taken, your heartbeat rate, calories burned, etc. Smartwatches and smart glasses went viral where everyone started manufacturing one, but again there isn't a perfect iteration by anyone. Wearables completely took over the booths at CES 2015, indicating that more and more manufacturers are showing their interest in wearable tech. Clearly, such devices have a huge potential in the health and medical field. To make things easier and competitive, Apple, Google and Microsoft have already released their health platforms, that uses all the collected data from wearables tracking your health and aggregating them together, measuring your health condition.

At CES 2015, Intel introduced a prototype of their Curie module, a really tiny microcomputer that could be used to create a broad range of wearable devices, across many form factors including